



swept-forward
cheek piece



snake-haired
Medusa figure

Medusa antefix

DATE UNKNOWN

This terra-cotta antefix—an ornament placed at the cornice of buildings or at roof eaves—is in the form of Medusa, the mythical creature whose gaze turned people to stone.



leaf-shaped blade

Corinthian helmet

600–500 BCE

The Corinthian helmet, made from a single bronze sheet, was the most common type in Greece, from around 750–300 BCE.

Spearhead

600–400 BCE

Greek hoplites (armed infantry soldiers) carried a large thrusting spear, of which this is the tip.



Aphrodite,
the goddess
of love

ANCIENT GREECE

FROM THE FUNCTIONAL TO THE DECORATIVE, THE GREEKS PRODUCED ART OF GREAT BEAUTY

While the Greeks created magnificent monumental art, smaller items such as jewelry, musical instruments, weaponry, and vases show the Greek love of intricate forms and decorative adornment throughout all periods of their history.

Greek art underwent a series of phases that were reflected in all aspects of artistic production, but particularly on vases. In the Geometric phase (c. 850–700 BCE), decoration was mainly composed of geometric forms, replaced in the Orientalizing phase (c. 700–600 BCE) with floral and animal themes, followed by the more naturalistic representations of the Classical phase (from 600 BCE).



Bronze cymbals

500–400 BCE

Greek cymbals are bell- or cup-shaped, and are often depicted on vases being held by fauns or satyrs, or by women in Bacchanalian revels.

cup-shaped form

Aulos

400 BCE

This wind instrument was originally a double one (one wooden pipe has been lost), played through a reed.

silver mouthpiece



finger hole

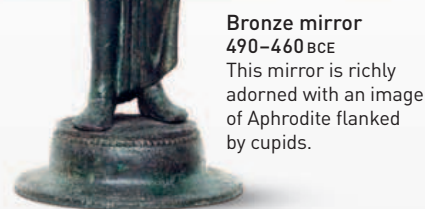


fastening
chain

Mirror lid and fibula

420–400 BCE

This silver fibula (brooch) and chain may have fastened together a cloak. The ornate mirror-back shows Aphrodite with the half-goat god Pan.



Bronze mirror

490–460 BCE

This mirror is richly adorned with an image of Aphrodite flanked by cupids.



Gold earrings

420–400 BCE

These delicate gold filigree earrings depict boats containing sirens, mythical creatures whose beautiful voices lured unwary seafarers to their doom.



Gold brooch

650–600 BCE

This hawk-shaped brooch dates from a period in which Oriental (and particularly Egyptian) influences were strong in Greece.